

Global Learning and Development (L&D) Policy

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Version: 2.1

Effective Date: April 1, 2024

Policy Owner: Total Rewards & Employee Wellness

Classification: Internal / Public (Employees)

1. Purpose and Objective

The Company believes in investing in the continuous professional growth of its workforce. The Global Learning and Development (L&D) Policy provides a structured framework for subsidizing employee education, industry certifications, and skill enhancement programs that align with the Company's strategic objectives.

2. Scope and Eligibility

- Eligibility:** Full-time permanent employees who have completed a minimum of **six (6) months of continuous service** are eligible to apply for L&D sponsorships.
- Exclusions:** Employees currently on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) or serving their notice period are ineligible for any financial allowances under this policy.

3. Financial Allowance and Budget

Eligible employees are entitled to an annual Learning Allowance.

- Standard Allowance:** Up to **USD 1,500** (or local equivalent) per financial year.
- Reset:** The allowance resets at the beginning of each financial year (January 1). Unused funds do not roll over to the subsequent year.
- Tax Implications:** In certain jurisdictions, educational reimbursements may be considered taxable income. The employee is responsible for any personal tax liabilities arising from this benefit.

4. Approved Learning Categories

The allowance may be utilized for the following approved categories, provided the subject matter is directly relevant to the employee's current role or an approved career progression path:

1. **Professional Certifications:** (e.g., AWS Certified Solutions Architect, PMP, CFA, SHRM-CP).
Covers exam fees and official preparatory materials.
2. **Short-Term Courses & Bootcamps:** Subscriptions to approved platforms (e.g., Coursera, Udacity, LinkedIn Learning) or specialized technical bootcamps.
3. **Industry Conferences & Seminars:** Registration and ticket fees for professional conferences (travel and accommodation must be expensed separately under the Global Travel Policy).
4. **Language Training:** Business-level language courses required for cross-regional collaboration.

5. Application and Reimbursement Process

1. **Pre-Approval:** Before purchasing any course or exam, the employee must submit an L&D Request via the HRMS portal. This requires explicit written approval from their direct Department Head.
2. **Payment:** The employee must pay for the course/exam upfront.
3. **Proof of Completion:** To claim the reimbursement via the Concur Expense System, the employee must submit:
 - Original payment receipts.
 - An official certificate of completion or a passing grade report.
 - *Note:* Reimbursement will be denied if the employee fails the exam, withdraws, or does not complete the coursework.

6. Retention Agreement and Repayment (Clawback)

The Company views L&D allowances as a mutual investment. To protect this investment, a retention clawback clause applies to high-value sponsorships.

- **Threshold:** Any single sponsorship or aggregated L&D expense exceeding **USD 1,000** in a rolling 12-month period triggers the retention agreement.
- **Repayment Terms:** If an employee voluntarily resigns or is terminated for cause within **12 months** of receiving the reimbursement, they are required to repay **100% of the reimbursed amount**.
- **Execution:** The owed amount will be automatically deducted from the employee's final payroll settlement.

7. Points of Contact

- **Tier 1 (Application & System Queries):** hr-helpdesk@company.com
- **Tier 2 (Reimbursement & Approvals):** hr-benefits@company.com
- **Tier 3 (Policy Exceptions):** Manager, Total Rewards.

8. Amendment History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	Sep 01, 2019	David Kim	Initial rollout of the education sponsorship program.
2.0	Jan 15, 2022	HR Benefits Team	Increased annual allowance from USD 1,000 to USD 1,500.
2.1	Mar 10, 2024	David Kim	Formally introduced the 12-month retention clawback clause for expenses over USD 1,000.

9. Authorizations and Signatures

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Approved By:

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Date: March 22, 2024